Japan's digital record-keeping rules



Aidan McFarlane

What counts as electronic

Email attachments

Invoices and quotes as PDF

Web downloads

Receipts from portals and EC

EDI and cloud

Invoices exchanged as data

Paper

Can stay paper, or be scanned

Saved as data

Searchable by date, amount and counterparty

Source: 国税庁 電子帳簿保存法

The three requirements

Requirement	What it means
真実性 Authenticity	Time stamp, change log, or internal rules
可視性 Visibility	Readable on screen and in print
検索性 Searchability	Find by date, amount and counterparty

Source: 国税庁 電子帳簿保存法 一問一答

Key dates and thresholds

1 Jan 2024	**Electronic storage becomes mandatory**
¥50m	**Sales threshold for the search exemption**
3	**Search keys: date, amount, counterparty**

Source: 国税庁 National Tax Agency

Working with Japanese finance



Format Clear PDFs: date, amount, company